

specific to their sub-genre. The aim of charity advertisements, and those designed to raise awareness of issues and events, is to have an immediate impact upon the audience to make them take notice; therefore, these advertisements need to be more memorable and hard-hitting.

- The producers of this sub-genre of advertisements are very aware of **compassion fatigue** and so will often aim to make advertisements that offer a different perspective on the issue or event, usually one that is more positive and upbeat. This approach is evident in *Super. Human.* with the use of **audio codes**. The choice of the soundtrack of *So You Want to be a Boxer* from Bussy Malone effectively communicates the struggles of the disabled athletes whilst giving the advertisement a positive feel. The more typical conventions, for example a voice-over and dramatic music, appear at the start of the advertisement, but rapidly change to the alarm and the realities of daily life. Sound effects underscore the music, emphasising the battle of training including grunts, groans and tape being applied.
- Advertisements have a limited amount of time to convey their message and so rely on **technical codes** and **editing** to do this rapidly. This advertisement uses close-up shots of expressions to engage the audience and to portray aspects of disability in a non-victim way, emphasising that this is part of their lives. For example, a range of shots are used to convey the strength and determination of the swimmer Ellie Simmonds, cutting between an establishing shot showing her alone in the pool, a close-up of her putting on her swimming goggles, a low angle shot creating power and an extreme close-up of her eyes connoting concentration. **Slow motion** is also used to show the cycling track crash combined with muting the sound for a more dramatic effect.
- **Visual codes** also communicate meanings. The **iconography and settings** are related to the athlete and the sport, for example Ellie Simmonds putting on her goggles in the pool, or training in the gym, but these settings are juxtaposed with domestic scenes of everyday life as a disabled person, suggesting the normality of their situation. **Gestures** communicate frustration, competition and celebration, visually

highlighting the result of the hard work.

- The **narrative** follows the lives of the Paralympians and their battles through training. The sequence where the athlete is trying to sing 'Happy Birthday' to his daughter on a mobile phone whilst training on a bike reinforces the clash between the sport and the family and further establishes the athletes as real people.
- There are also some more stylised sequences constructed to convey meaning. The dream sequence reappears later in the advert and is edited with a Channel 4 news clip announcing the postponement of the Games. The impact of this is shown as the athletes fall 'over the edge'.
- The advert also uses **humour** to convey information, for example, the image of the hamster on the wheel and the 'puke bucket' are recognisable visual signifiers of struggle. The animated sequences also insert aspects of the comic into what is a gruelling regime.

Consider theoretical perspectives Semiotics – Roland Barthes

- As advertisements have to communicate meaning rapidly, they use recognisable codes and conventions that signify messages for audiences to decode. In this advertisement, consider the connotations of the signs used. Clothing is used to rapidly place the athletes within their sport, for example, the track cyclist's clothing or the swimming costumes contrast with the athletes in their everyday life, such as the hospital clothing when the woman is giving birth or casual clothing when the wheelchair user tries to access the café. These signs serve to illustrate aspects of the lives of the people and creates realism.
- Consider how the advertisement also uses signs and codes to challenge the creation of myths around disability.

A level only:

Structuralism – Claude Lévi-Strauss

- How texts are constructed using **binary oppositions**. The images of gruelling training regimes are contrasted with the celebratory images at the end of the advertisement when success is achieved.